

Otter (Final Acres)

3/3/2026

SECTION C – DESCRIPTION/SPECIFICATION/WORK STATEMENT

Scope of Contract

This is an updated Section C document for the following timber sale:

- **Otter T.S. (Final Acres)** – Payment Units 01-14; 556 acres

This timber sale marking project involves timber marking and volume estimation of approximately 556 acres in Northern Hardwoods & Aspen forest types, broken down by the following descriptions:

(1) HARDWOOD SINGLE-TREE SELECTION (uneven-age) (Marking & Cruising)

Payment Units 01-14, 06-13; approximately 517 acres

Uneven aged stands or even-aged stands with uneven-aged or even-aged objectives consisting of a mixture of Northern Hardwood types of various size classes. These stands contain both pulpwood and sawtimber Species/Product/Unit mixes. Marking objectives are to remove trees considered high risk, defective, poor form, or mature and to maintain or develop size class structure with optimum growing stock, per the specific marking instructions.

(2) CLEARCUT/REMOVAL CUT (Marking & Cruising - where all trees are counted)

Payment Units 05 & 14; approximately 39 acres

Generally, in a clearcut or removal cut, where all LIVE and/or DEAD trees that meet minimum specifications for size or species are designated for removal EXCEPT for trees marked as RESERVE TREES, LEAVE TREES, or trees within PROTECTED AREAS.

In Payment Units where designated Species are too variable for Area Estimate Cruising methods, trees designated for removal will be marked with an intentional and discernable paint spot at eye level no smaller than 1 square inch to verify the tree was counted. Minimize over spray on non-designated species to avoid confusion. A stump mark is not generally required. Paint spots will face in generally the same direction. If any designated leave species (per marking instructions) are marked with a CTM designation, contractor will indicate this on tally card.

(3) SAMPLE TREE CRUISING METHOD

Applies to ALL Payment Units within the Otter T.S.

The Sample Tree cruising method (STR) involves measuring a specified proportion (Sample Interval) of trees in the defined sub-population. The remaining trees included for removal are tallied as count trees. With this cruising method, every tree included for removal must be visited and marked.

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NOTE: USFS *has not* marked the Road R.O.W. units for this sale yet. This will be done by USFS at a later date. For units that have a road running through them, contractor should still mark/cruise trees up to the edge of the existing road clearing.

NOTE: Government furnished tree marking paint (TMP) will be issued, or returned, by appointment only at the WATERSMEET RANGER DISTRICT OFFICE. The primary point of contact for all TMP transactions will be the paint custodian. This person will be identified at the pre-work meeting. BLUE paint has been designated for this sale.

NOTE: USFS will mark any and all Leave Trees.

NOTE: **Contractor will supply all gap locations on a map and coordinate this with the Contracting Officer Representative. **

This sale can be accessed from the following directions:

From Watersmeet, Travel west on US-2 for 25.6 miles. Turn north onto M-64 N and travel 3.3 miles. You will have reached the north portion of the sale with the sale being on the south side of M-64.